

the innocent north Indians is nothing but a clash of ego and the frustration of unrealised political dreams of Thackeray who has lost his following among the masses after splitting with the Shiv Sena.

RATAN SHARGA, *on e-mail*

On Tigers' Trail

The ongoing assault of the Sri Lankan Army on the strongholds of LTTE is indicative of its resolve to weed out the organisation from its soil ("Getting Prabhakaran", February 18). However, the Sri Lankan Government must initiate sincere measures to accommodate the Tamils on the island and help them feel secure.

K.V. RAGHURAM, *Wayanad*

If the Sri Lankan Government thinks that its recent successes would lead to the destruction of LTTE and capture of its supremo Prabhakaran, it could not have been less mistaken. Further ambushes will only lead to more blood being spilled. The country would be better placed if it works out a deal with LTTE.

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

No Gain, No Game

INDIA TODAY has rightly termed Sania Mirza's pull out from WTA Bangalore Open as "Not so Sporty" (Eyecatchers, February 18). Having cornered almost all Indian sports awards, Sania could not have achieved anything significant by playing at Bangalore.

B.H. AGARWAL, *Bhopal*

Fool's Paradise

The country's policy vis-a-vis China has always been

politically naive ("Belated Awakening", February 18). Defence Minister A.K. Antony's amazement at China's build-up along the border typifies this syndrome. Either our minister is not kept informed of what is happening at our doorsteps or there has been an abysmal intelligence failure. It seems we still suffer from the "Hindi-Cheeni bhai bhai" fixation.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYAN, *Mysore*

Doctors of Deceit

A renal transplant scandal of such magnitude could not have been possible without the help of transplant surgeons and skilled nephrologists and cushioning from politicians and bureaucrats ("The Kidney Mafia", February 11). It is high time that instead of focussing on a single man, the Government arrested the entire bunch of racketeers.

KIM MAMMEN, *Ludhiana*

THE BATTLE WITHIN



Of what use is India's emerging global status if we cannot control internal threats like Naxalism ("Red Terror", February 11). The country must bridge the gap between the haves and have-nots.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, *Bangalore*

Naxalites are now a decentralised group of agitators. To tackle them, the government has to negate the conditions that give rise to these extremists, a handful of who have been able to hold a large country like ours to ransom.

B.K. DUBEY, *Allahabad*

An unscrupulous India has pitched one bunch of people against another in the form of Salwa Judum. Violence is not a solution. The remedy lies in ruthless elimination of corruption, administrative transparency, de-criminalisation of politics and swift addressal of people's concerns.

BUNNIE LABEYRIE, *on e-mail*

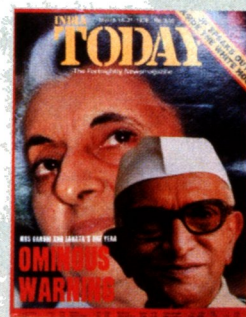
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30

Years Ago in India Today

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Celluloid Feuding

Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam leader (DMK) M. Karunanidhi has resorted to films in his battle with arch political enemy, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M.G. Ramachandran. Ramachandran—MGR to his fans—used his popularity as an actor to rise to his present political position. The DMK leader, whom MGR displaced as chief minister, is now trying



to beat the Karunanidhi incumbent at his own game. Karunanidhi too is not new to films. Many of the films he wrote scripts for have fared well at the box office. Earlier Karunanidhi had tried to promote his son Mu. Ka. Muthu, as a matinee idol to choke the pro-MGR distribution sector. Recently he motored to the famous AVM studios in Madras with much fanfare for the *mahurat* of *Nenjikki Needhi*, a film whose script he wrote. The actor he chose as hero was Jai Shankar—who has his own axe to grind against MGR.

—G.V. Rama Rao

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